

Treepolitics GCP Setup — Walkthrough

A short step-by-step checklist for Amr and Will to work through together in one sitting. Approximate time: 30 minutes.

Picking up mid-flight? The first attempt at this walkthrough on 2026-05-01 hit two unanticipated GCP changes (DRS now on by default; v1/v2 org-policy UI bug). If you're resuming partway through, read [gcp-setup-resume.md](#) first — it documents exactly where things left off and provides a Cloud Shell paste-block that completes the blocked steps.

For background, rationale, and troubleshooting, see the detailed doc at [docs/gcp-setup.md](#).

Who does what

- **WILL** — Will performs this step.
 - **AMR** — Amr performs this step.
 - **BOTH** — confirm together before moving on.
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Before you begin

Have these ready before starting the clock:

- ☐ **WILL** Spaceship account (create one at `spaceship.com` if needed).
 - ☐ **WILL** A personal email (e.g. Gmail) you can receive mail at.
 - ☐ **WILL** The company credit card.
 - ☐ **WILL** An authenticator app on your phone (Google Authenticator, 1Password, Authy) — Google will force 2FA during setup.
 - ☐ **WILL** A password manager entry ready to store new credentials.
 - ☐ **AMR** Logged in to your Spaceship account (the one that owns `treepolitics.net` right now).
 - ☐ **AMR** Logged in to `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` in a browser.
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Phase 1 — Transfer `treepolitics.net` to Will (5 minutes)

Goal: Will becomes the registrant of `treepolitics.net` on Spaceship.

1. **AMR** In Spaceship, open the management page for `treepolitics.net`.
 2. **AMR** Find the option to **push / transfer to another Spaceship account** (look for "Push to another account", "Transfer to another user", or "Account transfer" — *not* "Transfer out to another registrar", which is the slow ICANN route).
 3. **AMR** Enter Will's Spaceship account email. Submit.
 4. **WILL** Open the notification in your Spaceship account and **accept** the transfer.
 5. **BOTH** Confirm: -
☐
WILL `treepolitics.net` shows up under his domains. -
☐
WILL Can open the DNS panel and see existing records. -
☐
AMR `treepolitics.net` no longer appears in his Spaceship account.
-

Phase 2 — Create the Cloud Identity on `treepolitics.net` (10 minutes)

Goal: Will creates a Google Cloud Identity Free account tied to `treepolitics.net`. This gives us the GCP Organization.

Important to understand before starting

Will is about to **invent** an admin username. Right now nothing `@treepolitics.net` exists anywhere in Google. During signup, Will types `admin` and — at that moment — `admin@treepolitics.net` is created as a **Google login credential only**, not a mailbox. Emails sent to that address will bounce, forever, until/unless we set up email separately. That is fine; GCP does not need mail delivery to work.

Steps

1. **WILL** Open `https://workspace.google.com/gcpidentity/signup?sku=identitybasic` in an **incognito window** (prevents tangling with any existing Google login). The marketing page at `cloud.google.com/identity` no longer surfaces the Free signup directly — Google has moved it under Workspace marketing. The `?sku=identitybasic` query parameter is what selects the \$0 Free edition rather than a paid Workspace plan.
2. **WILL** Click **Get started free** (or "Start free trial" — the product is *Cloud Identity Free Edition*, \$0).
3. **WILL** Fill in the business info: - Business name: `Treepolitics` - Employees: 1 - Region: your country
4. **WILL** Contact info: use **your personal email** (Gmail). This is just for setup confirmations — it is not the admin account.
5. **WILL** Domain: enter `treepolitics.net`, confirm "Yes, I have a domain I can use".
6. **WILL** Create the admin account: - Username: `admin` → becomes `admin@treepolitics.net` - Password: generate a strong one and **save it in your password manager immediately**.
7. **WILL** Agree and continue. You are now in `admin.google.com`. Bookmark this URL.

Verify the domain via DNS

Google will show a TXT record to add.

1. **WILL** Open a new tab → Spaceship DNS panel for `treepolitics.net`.

2. **WILL** Add a **TXT record**: - Host / Name: @ (or blank — the apex of the domain) - Value: paste the full `google-site-verification=...` string **exactly** - TTL: default
3. **WILL** Save. Wait ~1 minute for propagation.
4. **WILL** Back in the Google setup tab, click **Verify**. Retry if it fails the first time.
 - ☐ **WILL** Google confirms the domain is verified.
 - ☐ **WILL** The organization `treepolitics.net` now exists.

Set the recovery email (CRITICAL — do not skip)

Because `admin@treepolitics.net` is not a real mailbox, password resets would bounce without this.

1. **WILL** In `admin.google.com` → **Directory** → **Users**.
2. **WILL** Click `admin@treepolitics.net`.
3. **WILL** Expand **Security** → **Recovery information**.
4. **WILL** Enter your personal email as the recovery email. Add your phone number as a recovery phone if desired.
5. **WILL** Save.
 - ☐ **WILL** Recovery email is set to your personal email.

Enable 2FA

1. **WILL** In `admin.google.com` → **Security** → **Authentication** → **2-step verification**.
 2. **WILL** Turn on enforcement for the admin account.
 3. **WILL** Log out, log back in. Enroll your authenticator app when prompted.
 - ☐ **WILL** 2FA is active on `admin@treepolitics.net`.
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Phase 3 — Create the billing account (5 minutes)

Goal: A billing account exists under Will's identity, and Amr has `Billing Account User` access on it.

Create the billing account

1. **WILL** Go to `console.cloud.google.com/billing`. Log in as `admin@treepolitics.net` if prompted.
 2. **WILL** In the top bar, confirm the **organization selector** shows `treepolitics.net`. If it says "No organization", stop — Phase 2 did not complete correctly.
 3. **WILL** Click **Create account**.
 4. **WILL** Fill in: - Name: `Treepolitics – Main` - Country: Treepolitics's billing country (**cannot be changed later**) - Currency: auto-selected, confirm it is correct
 5. **WILL** Payment information: enter the company card. Include tax ID / VAT if applicable (harder to add later).
 6. **WILL** Click **Submit and enable billing**.
- ☐ **WILL** Billing account `Treepolitics – Main` exists.

Grant Amr access

1. **WILL** In **Billing**, open the new account.
 2. **WILL** Go to **Account management** (sometimes called **Permissions**) in the left nav.
 3. **WILL** Click **Add principal**.
 4. **WILL** Enter `amr@agtechgroup.solutions`.
 5. **WILL** Role: **Billing Account User** (`roles/billing.user`) — *not* Administrator. User lets Amr link projects without giving him the ability to edit Will's payment method.
 6. **WILL** Save.
- ☐ **WILL** `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` appears as a Billing Account User.

Create a budget alert

Because `admin@treepolitics.net` bounces, we need to explicitly route budget notifications to real inboxes.

1. **WILL** In **Billing** → **Budgets & alerts**, click **Create budget**.
 2. **WILL** Name: `Treepolitics monthly – alert only`.
 3. **WILL** Scope: all projects on this billing account.
 4. **WILL** Amount: pick a ceiling that would alert you before anything runaway — e.g. **\$100 / month** for now. This is an alert threshold only — GCP does not auto-stop services when you hit it.
 5. **WILL** Actions → **Manage notifications** → **Email recipients**, explicitly add: - Will's personal email - `amr@agtechgroup.solutions`
 6. **WILL** Save.
 - ☐ **WILL** Budget exists with both emails as notification recipients.
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Phase 4 — Grant Amr IAM roles at the organization level (3 minutes)

Goal: Amr has organization-level admin on GCP resources via his existing `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` email.

4a — Will first grants himself the GCP IAM roles he'll need

Cloud Identity Super Admin (`admin@treepolitics.net`) does **not** automatically come with GCP IAM roles on the org. Without an explicit self-grant, Will sees "You need additional access" on the IAM and Org Policies pages and can't grant Amr anything. Bootstrap path:

1. **WILL** Go to `console.cloud.google.com/iam-admin/iam`.
2. **WILL** Confirm the top selector shows `treepolitics.net` (the org, not a project). Super Admins always have implicit access to this page even with no IAM bindings — that's how the bootstrap works.
3. **WILL** **Grant access** → New principal: `admin@treepolitics.net` (himself). Add these roles:
 - **Organization Administrator** (`roles/resourcemanager.organizationAdmin`) -
 - Organization Policy Administrator** (`roles/orgpolicy.policyAdmin`)
4. **WILL** Save. Wait ~30 seconds, hard-refresh the page.

4b — Grant Amr the four org-level roles

1. **WILL** Go to `console.cloud.google.com/iam-admin/iam`.
2. **WILL** In the top bar, change the resource scope to the **Organization** (`treepolitics.net`).
This is the most common mistake in the whole setup — if you grant roles while a project is selected, they do not cascade. Make sure the selector shows `treepolitics.net`, not a project.
3. **WILL** Click **Grant access**.
4. **WILL** New principal: `amr@agtechgroup.solutions`
5. **WILL** Add these four roles (use **Add another role** between each): -
 - ☐ **Organization Administrator** (`roles/resourcemanager.organizationAdmin`) -
 - ☐ **Project Creator** (`roles/resourcemanager.projectCreator`) -
 - ☐ **Organization Role Administrator** (`roles/iam.organizationRoleAdmin`) -
 - ☐

Folder Admin (`roles/resourcemanager.folderAdmin`)

6. **WILL** Save.

Verify Amr can access the org

1. **AMR** Open `console.cloud.google.com` in your own browser and log in as `amr@agtechgroup.solutions`.
2. **AMR** Click the organization selector in the top bar. Pick `treepolitics.net`.
3. **AMR** Navigate to **IAM & Admin** → **IAM**. Confirm your email shows the four roles listed above.
 - ☐ **AMR** Can see `treepolitics.net` in the org selector.
 - ☐ **AMR** All four roles appear against his principal.

! Domain Restricted Sharing is now ON BY DEFAULT for new Cloud Identity orgs (this changed sometime in 2024–2025 as part of Google's "secure-by-default" rollout). The policy `iam.allowedPolicyMemberDomains` will already be enforcing `allowedValues: [<your customer ID>]`, which blocks IAM grants to external principals — including Amr's `amr@agtechgroup.solutions`. You'll hit a "Domain Restricted Sharing is enforced" error the first time you try to add him.

! The Org Policies UI is currently buggy on this constraint. The "Override → Replace → Allow all" save renders the policy as "Inactive" but a v1/v2 API mismatch means enforcement continues. Do not waste time fighting the UI — relax the policy via gcloud Cloud Shell instead:

```
ORG_ID=$(gcloud organizations list --format="value(ID)" | head -1)
cat > /tmp/drs-allow-all.yaml <<EOF
name: organizations/${ORG_ID}/policies/iam.allowedPolicyMemberDomains
spec:
  rules:
    - allowAll: true
EOF
gcloud org-policies set-policy /tmp/drs-allow-all.yaml
```

Verify with `gcloud org-policies describe iam.allowedPolicyMemberDomains --organization=$ORG_ID` — must show `spec.rules: [- allowAll: true]`.

This leaves DRS off entirely. As a hardening pass within a week, swap `allowAll: true` for an explicit allowlist of both Cloud Identity customer IDs (treepolitics.net's own + agtechgroup.solutions' for Amr). See [gcp-setup-resume.md](#) for the allowlist YAML.

Phase 5 — Create the `treepolitics-prod` project (3 minutes)

Goal: The first (and for now, only) project exists and is linked to billing.

1. **AMR** Go to `console.cloud.google.com/projectcreate`.
 2. **AMR** Fill in: - **Project name:** `treepolitics-prod` - **Project ID:** `treepolitics-prod` if available, otherwise add a short suffix like `-01`. **IDs are globally unique and cannot be changed later.** - **Organization:** `treepolitics.net`. If it says "No organization", stop — Phase 4 did not complete correctly. - **Location:** the organization itself (no folder for now).
 3. **AMR** Click **Create**.
 4. **AMR** Open the new project → **Billing** in the left nav → **Link a billing account** → select `Treepolitics – Main`.
 - ☐ **AMR** `treepolitics-prod` exists under `treepolitics.net`.
 - ☐ **AMR** `treepolitics-prod` is linked to `Treepolitics – Main`.
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Final checklist

Tick each before declaring the walkthrough complete. If any fails, see `docs/gcp-setup.md` Appendix B for troubleshooting.

- ☐ Will is the registrant of `treepolitics.net` on Spaceship.
 - ☐ `treepolitics.net` organization appears in the GCP org selector.
 - ☐ `admin@treepolitics.net` has a working 2FA setup.
 - ☐ `admin@treepolitics.net` has Will's personal email as its recovery email.
 - ☐ Billing account `Treepolitics – Main` exists and has a valid card.
 - ☐ `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` is a `Billing Account User`.
 - ☐ Budget alert exists with Will's personal email and `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` as recipients.
 - ☐ `amr@agtechgroup.solutions` has the four IAM roles at the org scope.
 - ☐ Amr has logged in and confirmed he can see `treepolitics.net`.
 - ☐ `treepolitics-prod` exists, parented to the org, linked to billing.
 - ☐ Domain Restricted Sharing is **not** enabled on the org.
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If something goes wrong

Pause the walkthrough and open `docs/gcp-setup.md` → Appendix B. Common issues:

- **DNS TXT verification fails:** use `toolbox.googleapps.com/apps/dig/#TXT/` to confirm the record is live, then retry.
 - **Org does not appear in console:** log out / log back in — new orgs sometimes do not appear in an existing session.
 - **Amr cannot see the org:** he most likely has a project selected in the top bar, not the org — switch the selector filter to "Organization".
 - **Will forgets the admin password:** use "Forgot password" on the login screen; recovery code goes to his personal email via the recovery email set in Phase 2.
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Next session (no Will needed): Amr begins the actual API migration inside `treepolitics-prod` — Cloud Run, Cloud SQL, Secret Manager, Artifact Registry. Will does not need to be involved again unless a budget alert fires.